MINUTES FROM THE COUNCIL UNITED FOR WORLD DESTRUCTION
(The Council of Doom)
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Prologue:

Lights up on four shadowy figures, sitting at a table: THE DARK KNIGHT, a renaissance fair refugee; SEA-MAN, self-proclaimed Spanish lord of the sea; SHE-MALE, a muscle woman with sunglasses and an attitude, and ROBOTO, a robot.

There is also BANJO, a girl sitting with a guitar. There seems to be nothing especially evil or bizarre about her.

Yet.

Banjo tunes the guitar, sees the audience. She seems to exist in a different space then the villains.

BANJO:
On a Saturday, in the month of December
Not too terribly long ago.
The world was almost destroyed
By a most Demented Foe

A Madman! A Genius! My friends,
A man not born to push a broom-
A Name soon the world would fear-
Professor Gregory Von Doom!

(she begins to rock out)

DOOM! DOOM! GREGORY VON DOOM!
YEAH! YEAH! MR. DOOM TO YOU!
DOOM! DOOM! GREGORY VON DOOM!
HE MADE ME GO CLEAN UP MY ROOM!

(calms down)

He called for the greatest villains
To help him on his quest
And when they could not make it
He made some calls and got the rest

But who are these fools? Do they not realize
they are but their brides, he their groom?
What evil plot have they fallen into-
The minions of Professor- Gregory-

VON DOOM! DOOM! GREGORY VON DOOM!
HE MAKES ALL THE LADIES SWOON!
DOOM! DOOM! GREGORY VON DOOM!
I'VE RUN OUT OF WORDS TO RHYME WITH DOOOOOOOMMMM!

Lights shift.

Meeting One:

The villains resume action in real time.

KNIGHT:
Verily, How was thy trip?

SHE-MALE:
The trip was fine. The hour waiting for my f-ing luggage was a bore.

Pause. ROBOTO beeps.

SHE-MALE:
Uh huh. Right. (looks at Sea-man) So, what's your deal?

SEA-MAN:
Mi nombre es Seaman!

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
(a device that SEA-MAN carries, which comes out in a cherpy, friendly voice.)
My name is the Seaman!

SEA-MAN:
(lustfully) Soy el tyrant del mar!

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
I am The Tyrant of the Sea!

ROBOTO:
One Zero Zero Zero Zero One Zero One.

SHE-MALE:
We're getting paid for this, right?

PROFESSOR GREGORY VON DOOM enters in a grand fashion. He has spent a lot of time on his costume.

DOOM:
Gentlemen. Welcome to my lair. I have gathered, from the—(stops) are we all here? (to an empty chair) We're one short. Banjo, did you- Oh, right. I liquidated Banjo.

BANJO:
No, you didn't.

DOOM:
Oh. (thinks) Then who's in the liquidator?

BANJO:
(beat) Squeakums… You *sick bastard.*

BANJO stalks offstage. DOOM turns back to the group.

DOOM:
(to the group) Did anyone see—I know this is, this is not normal but did anyone see a giant talking cucumber in the parking lot. Anyone. Anyone at all. Giant talking cucumber. Hard to miss.

Roboto beeps, opens his stomach drawer and pulls out a plate of sliced cucumber. All stare at it. Doom takes a large breath.

DOOM:
Super. Alright. Focus. (closes eyes, to self) You've got the touch. You've got the power. You are a chestnut of possibility (hums offkey, then opens his eyes and-) I have brought you here for one purpose. There's been a lot of *talk*- from a lot of would be-s and never-haves and oh I should but you know my schedule, it's not going to *fit in* this week- a lot of talk about destroying the world. I want US… Let's be the group that *does* something about it. We shall make the world… QUAKE… WITH…. FEAR!!!!!! (thunder) But first. Banjo? (Banjo enters, with a pot.) Go to the deli and get some dip, please. Wait. What is that?

BANJO:
The Dip.

DOOM:
I thought we were out.

BANJO:
We used to have Squeakums the giant hamster. Now we have dip.

DOOM:
I don't-

BANJO:
LIQUIDATOR!

DOOM:
…it begins.

DOOM takes the dip and begins to serve out parts of the dead cucumber. BANJO sings a song.

G.T.C.

Giant Talking Cucumber, my G.T.C.
Goodbye, my friend, we hardly knew ye

Maybe you were tall, maybe short and fat
We won't ever know, and that my friend is that

and that my friend is that
and that my friend is that
that, my G.T.C., is that

Alas, Alack, you never even made it onstage
The writer wrote you, but left you off the page

Rest in peace, G.T.C. I know you had the nerve
But now you're in my stomach, a tasty hors d'oeuvre

Meeting Two:

Lights up mid-argument:

DOOM:

Red wine!

SHE-MALE:
White wine!

DOOM:
Red wine!

SHE-MALE:
White wine!

DOOM:
Is it *your* council untied for world destruction? No. It's mine. And I say we're drinking-

SEA-MAN:
Idiota! I hundido el titanic con el spunk en mi pinky!

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
I am afraid you are mistaken. I am the person who sunk the Titanic with the spunk in my small finger!

KNIGHT:
(grabs the translator, screaming into it)
Would ye stop HOUNDING MY BRAIN like a JACKAL with your DEMON language?! (begins to weep)

BANJO:
How about a Blush wine? A Rose'? Anyone for Rose'. (to ROBOTO) I like Rose'.

DOOM:
People, people!

ROBOTO
Zero.

DOOM:
And Robot. The idiot in the armor has a point. We all need to curse at each other in the same tongue. Otherwise, the forces of good have already won. Some say they already have. That is the purpose of this union! You summon, here's what you do- you summon, from the farthest corners of the galaxy- the greatest villains of all time-

SHE-MALE:
Excuse me?

DOOM:
The greatest low life scum, the- yes?

SHE-MALE:
Uh, yeah. I'm from Detroit, and, I believe I put that on my resume-

DOOM:
Yes?

SHE-MALE:

Suburbs of Detroit, actually. The point is, I'm not actually from another, how do I put this- Galaxy? And I don't believe that was ever on the job posting.

KNIGHT:
Verily, I am from the Middle Ages, under the reign of King John. We do not believe in planets.

SEA-MAN:
Vengo del país del amor, bebé.

SEA-MAN's TRANSLATOR:
I come from the country named love. Baby.

DOOM:
Okay. FINE. This council is made up of a woman from Detriot, a Knight from the Middle Ages, a Fish-Man

SEA-MAN
SEAMAN!!!

SEA-MAN TRANSLATOR
I am the Sea-Man-

DOOM:
A SEAMAN from the deep briny deeps of love, and a Robot from… (stares at the Robot) Well, a Robot. He doesn't need to be BE from anywhere.

BANJO:
And Banjo.

DOOM:
Yes, and Banjo. Until she gets liquidated.

BANJO:
Oh yeah? Oh yeah? Well maybe you should make yourself the Mayor of JERKVILLE, because you obviously are the FOUNDER! Established in 1898- by Dr. Gregory JERK!

SEA-MAN
(to the Knight) Que? "jerk-ville?" No cophrehende.

SEA-MAN's TRANSLATOR:
What is that? I do not understand this ERROR ERROR ERROR

BANJO:
I hate you Dad! (runs offstage)

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
ERROR ERROR ERROR ER-

The Knight grabs the Translator and breaks it in half.

DOOM:

Let that be a lesson to all of you. Time travel yields dubious results. You try to go back and fix the Spanish American War, you return with a guitar playing hippy-dippy daughter and one hundred and two years of back-alimony.

ROBOTO:
One one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one one Zero.

SHE-MALE:
(sighs) Look, can we at least agree that the… 'council' needs an immediate deli run? All in favor say Aye.

ALL:
Aye.

ROBOTO (after):
Yes.

They all stare at it. DOOM stands, contemplating.

ROBOTO:
Er. One. Zero.

They all pull their various instruments of destruction. KNIGHT, his sword; SEA-MAN, his fish, DOOM, his Doom Ray, and SHE-MALE, her bitchiness.

ROBOTO:
One?

DOOM:
(quietly) Sic Semper Falsus Robotum.

Lights go down fast as they move in on him, we can only see Banjo. She strums the guitar, then rocks out hardcore:

ROBOTO

Every Sci-Fi Movie
From Nineteen-Eighty On
Every one worth watching
(Thus excluding Tron)

Makes it very very very clear
To man and boy the same
To Never ever Trust a Robot (Ever Ever Trust a Robot)
This is not a game!

Oooh Oooh Oooh Oooh Oooh

During this part, we see flashes of light as the Four dismantle ROBOTO stylistically-

They'll wait until you sleep at night
They'll crust your pets with Metal Might

(Might! Metal Might!)
They'll grind and clang and rip you up
They'll blaster your master and never stop!
(Never Stop! Never Stop!)

Regarding our little carboard friend-
About his rather unfortunate end-
Consider this his eulogy
I hope you'd do the same for me.
We'll nail a sign up to a tree
And leave there for all to see-

NEVER TRUST A ROBOT
NEVER EVER TRUST A ROBOT
NEVER EVER EVER EVER EVER
AND IF YOU DO…
Serves you right.

Meeting Three:

Beer, Snacks everywhere. Roboto has a bowl of guacamole sitting where his head used to be. SEA-MAN is applying some tape to his translator. SHE-MALE is holding the head. Some wine spritzers have been drunk by all. Especially BANJO.

DOOM:
That's how we deal with interlopers. Got it? No Interloping on my watch. (holding the agenda) Now, when shall we three meet again?

KNIGHT:
Are there not four of us? Forsooth, there are.

DOOM:
Alright, screw it. (crumples up the paper)

SHE-MALE:
It just ripped right off when I pulled at it. (offers it to the Sea-man) Damndest thing.

DOOM:
Dark Knight, my friend. We bought that Mutton Jerky, and I must insist you eat it. (as Sea-Man puts on the Robot Head)

KNIGHT:
Nay, my good sir. Hast though tried it? Thyne Bowels moveth not for a week.

BANJO:
Oh? Did your bowels move when you ate my HAMSTER DIP?

KNIGHT
(quietly) Was that not Guacamole?

BANJO:
Does Guacamole have a tail?

The KNIGHT throws up in his own helmet, which is worse than it sounds, and shortly afterwards, he falls on the ground begins screaming. DOOM tries to regain control-

DOOM:
Moving right along. We can, uh-

SEA-MAN
Beeepe! Uno! Nada! Uno!

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
One! Zero! One!

DOOM:
You. Fishboy. Take that off.

SEA-MAN:
No estoy usando la cabeza de la robusteza.

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
I am not using the head of the robot, my Good Man.

DOOM:
Spaniard. Listen to me. I will burn you like a child in the strange world of Roahl Dahl.

SEA-MAN:
cómame, mi amigo.

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR
Eat me! ... my good friend.

DOOM:
No abla dead-man. Fishboy.

Beat. Show-down. Knight and SHE-MALE slide back from the table. DOOM knocks the translator out of his hand.

SEA-MAN
Hey! I paid thirty bucks for- (stops) Er. No solo… trece de… Radioshack-o…

Sea-Man suddenly bolts, Doom runs after him screaming. Banjo strums the guitar.

KNIGHT:
(after a beat, to SHE-MALE) You art the most grotesque, yet ravishing creature I hath ever seen.

She stares at him as the song starts-

Sea-Man

BANJO:

Sea-Man, Sea-Man
The Spanish Faking He-Man

Sea-Man, No more he waves
As we salsa on his grave

Ariba! We urge him on
Andre, to the ocean's son
But what is this? My God, what baloney!
This fishman's nothing but a phony!

One lousy little mutant shark
Where's his Bite? Only Bark!
Not only that, but it gets worse
He knows no Spanish- not one verse!

This Euro trash,
the unshaven scum
Wants to know
just how it's done

We'll teach him how-
'se abla engles?'
Down he goes
To his proper place

Oui Oui, he won't leave this room
Until he gets a healthy dose of DOOM!

Meeting Four:

As before. Roboto's headless body now holds a bowl of guacamole. Sea-Man is propped in his chair, dead. Knight seems recently beaten-up, yet strangely happy about it. SHE-MALE is not amused. Doom is trying to keep it together. He hold's Sea-Man's translator in his hand. Many more wine spritzers have been drunk.

DOOM:
It was so simple. You get a bunch of people together. You try to take over the world. And it all goes to hell. (*he presses a button.*)

SEA-MAN'S TRANSLATOR:
Please, my good friend, stop shoving my head into my-

DOOM:
(*he clicks it off, takes a long swig of Spritzer*) You know, I blew up a bank the other day. I have them all there, before the, you know, the big boom- and I ask them if they've got any last words. Now I've heard it all- please don't kill me, my wife and kids, I never saw the Astrodome, et cetera. But I ask the guy, any last words. He says, "Yeah," and he turns to his boss and he says, "Bill, I just want you to know. I've been stealing the toilet paper from here for years." And the boss mulls this and says, "Dave, you're fired." And then VASHOOM, the whole place was vaporized, just like that.(*another sip*) Now that's a true story.

SHE-MALE
Does it have a point?

DOOM:
Silence. And YES. It does. People just- I don't know, it's a new world out there, a sad world. Used to be, you shoved a death ray in their face, you point a nuclear missle at them, they'd pay attention. Now? Credit card bills and wireless internets and aaaah, I don't know. Nothing grabs their interest anymore. You're another blip on their radar. (*takes a sip*) Anyway. So. Where were we?

SHE-MALE:
Your plan.

DOOM:
Yes. The plan. I worked on it a very long time. I have learned from our ancestors. I watched every episode of G.I. Joe that was commercially available (*beat*) Because, they had some good ideas, but every time, Hubris. Hubris was the flaw. We don't have that. We have five of the… we have three, three of the biggest, baddest villains out there. Now I say we take this eight point implementation plan of Doom, and we say to the World; 'hey world?? What's up? Me. Us. That's what's up." (*beat*) Banjo. Where's the eight point implenetation plan of doom?

BANJO:
The EPIPD? I think, last I saw it, you were stuffing down the fish-man's throat.

KNIGHT AND SHE-MALE:
Sea-Man.

BANJO:
Sea-Man, right. Yeah. It's in his carcass. (*Doom puts his head in his hands*) You want me to go get it?

DOOM:
I want a lot of things, Banjo. Peace. Love. The World. But I don't think I'm going to get them.

KNIGHT:
Verily, it might have been a good plan, fair and true. (*pregnant pause*) Would it not already be digested. Although I recall, not too terribly long ago, another man with a plan. A demon with an angel's face- learn well, my friends, that the pen is always mightier than the sword, for when he was done….oh, Chaucer! Why, Chaucer!? I tell ye one little olde story and my good turned to evile! Now I maketh less then $3.75 an hour, and not even a sliver of booty to show for it? Beware… BEWA-

Doom quickly breaks the Knight's neck. He collapses in the chip bowl. SHE-MALE is stunned. Thunder.

DOOM:
Bum Bum Bum. Another bites the Dust. Bum Bum Bum. Another one *bites-*

Quick blackout. Lights up on Banjo.

KNIGHT SONG-

Sleep sound, sleep tight
My dear, dead, Dark Knight

This Stupid Geek, He saw no wrong
In Bitching Bitching Bitching Bitching
All night long.

Bitching Bitching Bitching all night long
Bitching Bitching Bitching all night long.

Why bother to wake the dead
When you'd rather spend all day in bed?
Why carry a big badass blade-
When you'd rather eat those cookies-
-you know the ones with the chocolate and the white chocolate and they're kind of gooey and probably really bad for you but who cares- that my mom made?

Bitching Bitching Bitching all night long
Bitching Bitching Bitching all night long.

He bitches and whines and then he mopes
Stays home crying and watching his soaps
He's very shiny but not all that bright-
My Dear, Dearest, Dead Dark Knight

Bitching Bitching Bitching all night long
Bitching Bitching Bitching all night long.
Bitching Bitching Bitching Bitching
All night long.

Meeting Five:

As before. Knight and Sea-Man are propped in their chairs with chip-bags on their heads. Roboto's body has now been dismantled to serve as several bowls for chips, dip. SHE-MALE is uneasy, as Doom has clearly gone insane.

DOOM:
So, in conclusion… while I considered, for a time, sparing this little planet, you four… (looks around) Well, YOU, have been chosen to witness it's… *dismemberment*. To all the citizens of earth… prepare for extermination. I am your new King- Professor Gregory Von-

SHE-MALE:
King of who? Me and the headless tin man over here? Look at us- we didn't even have a unified theme! I'm a Amazon- how was I supposed to work with a demented Medieval Reject? Crush his skull like a grapefruit and charge admission? Oh, sing an ironic song about our deaths, *that'll* destroy the world. And the poor bastard Spaniard used all of that ocean garbage to pick up women. The robot wasn't even a robot- look at him, his metal is cardboard! Did you even *look* at his references? You didn't think this through, did you? (beat) Oh God. I killed a man.

DOOM:
You're right. What was I thinking? This is so silly. I'm sorry. Oh, SHE-MALE? (she looks up) It's Von *DOOM!!*

Doom screams and lunges. A brief struggle. SHE-MALE has the upper hand until a ray gun goes off, killing her. Doom is triumphant. Banjo sings sadly, but with a sick smile.

SHE MALE SONG-

She-Male, She-Male-
Were you even ever Female?
She-Male, She-Male
Now you're only a dream-mail-

Suddenly, DOOM suddenly lurches over. He stares a Banjo, wild-eyed-

DOOM:
You-! (wide-eyed, grasping stomach, enraged) My appendix!?

BANJO:
Time travel does funny things. When you went back to stop the Spanish American War, you didn't just create a daughter with separation issues. You also created an alternate timeline, where your appendix was *never taken out*…

DOOM:
The Appendix Scenario… No…

BANJO:
And the prophecy is fulfilled, father… I am your legacy!

DOOM:
you cannot… destroy… my… destiny! (dies)

A moment. Then, A GIANT TALKING CUCUMBER enters, looking sheepish, carrying luggage.

GIANT TALKING CUCUMBER:
Sorry I'm so late… you would not *believe* what happened to my- (stops) Ooh. Bad time?

BANJO:
Nah. (beat) Hi I'm Banjo.

GIANT TALKING CUCUMBER:
Nice to meet you. I'm -

BANJO:
Don't tell me. You're the Giant Talking Cucumber.

GIANT TALKING CUCUMBER:
The one and only.

BANJO:
You want some Robot/Hampster Guacamole?

G.T.C:
I'd be delighted!

ENDING SONG-

It's Saturday, in the month of December
And the world is safe- for now.

No more Gregory, his appendix did him in
But of the Von Dooms, this I vow

That the world with Shiver
The governments will Quiver
And soon the world will Quake with Fear…

Get ready for…

BANJO! BANJO! BANJO VON DOOM!
SHE'S MS KICKASS VILLAIN QUEEN BADASS TO YOU!
BANJO! BANJO! BANJO VON DOOM!
SHE'S COMING TO KICK YOUR ASS-
AT A THEATRE NEAR YOU!!!!!!

During the final song, the Cucumber eats a piece of cucumber without realizing it- then realizes it, and dies from the horror/shock.

BANJO laughs as evilly as possible. Then she has a piece of Cucumber with dip on it.

Thunder. Fade out. End.

ALL THE OTHER STUFF

Summary:
The world was almost destroyed recently by the Committee United for World Destruction (C.U.W.D.). What follows is the account of why the world was spared.

Production Notes:
Your first reaction will probably be, "how the hell can we afford all this?" The answer is, don't. The robot is made of cardboard (literally) the ray gun should be purchased at Wall-Mart and the Cucumber should be nothing more than a man in a green garbage bag. However, it should be noted that none of them *knows* they're ridiculous (except arguably the SHE-MALE.) The more seriously the actors play the material, and act in their ridiculous garb, the better. Of course, should you decide to spend money on the project—should the Sea-Man actually have a trident, for instance—I can't stop you. But it might take away from the overall effect.

Banjo's songs. Banjo in general. She is the oompa-loompa of this enterprise. Except in the end, she kills Willy Wonka. Let her be just as creepy/awesome/strangely rehearsed.

Should you decide to do it without the songs, again, I can't stop you. At the time of publication, no music as been written, it's just lyrics. But any amount of guitar strumming or, basically, anyone with musical talent and a taste for improvisation can make it work.

Finally, the Giant Talking Cucumber can be played by a different actor, but I have structured it in a way so that Roboto can play him/her (as the robot is disabled by the time that the Cucumber arrives.) However, do not list the actor playing Roboto as also playing the Cucumber. If you decide to have a separate cast member play the cucumber, make it a cameo- do not list him/her in the cast. Do not list the Cucumber in program at all, basically, so that no one sees it coming. Especially not the Cucumber. (If you're worried about people getting that it's a Giant Cucumber, feel free to put a sticker on the luggage that says "Property of G. Cucumber", or something to that effect.)

Bio:

Taylor Shann is a jack of all trades, master of some. He writes, he directs, he produces and he often gets drunk and leaves his friends long, rambling voicemails about what a great person they are. *Minutes from the C.U.W.D.* is by far the most fun he has ever had writing a play. Some of his longer plays are published online by The Mushroom Cloud Press (mushroomcloudpress.com) He lives in New York and works at Samuel French Inc., the oldest play publisher in the world. Graduated Tufts University, 2004.